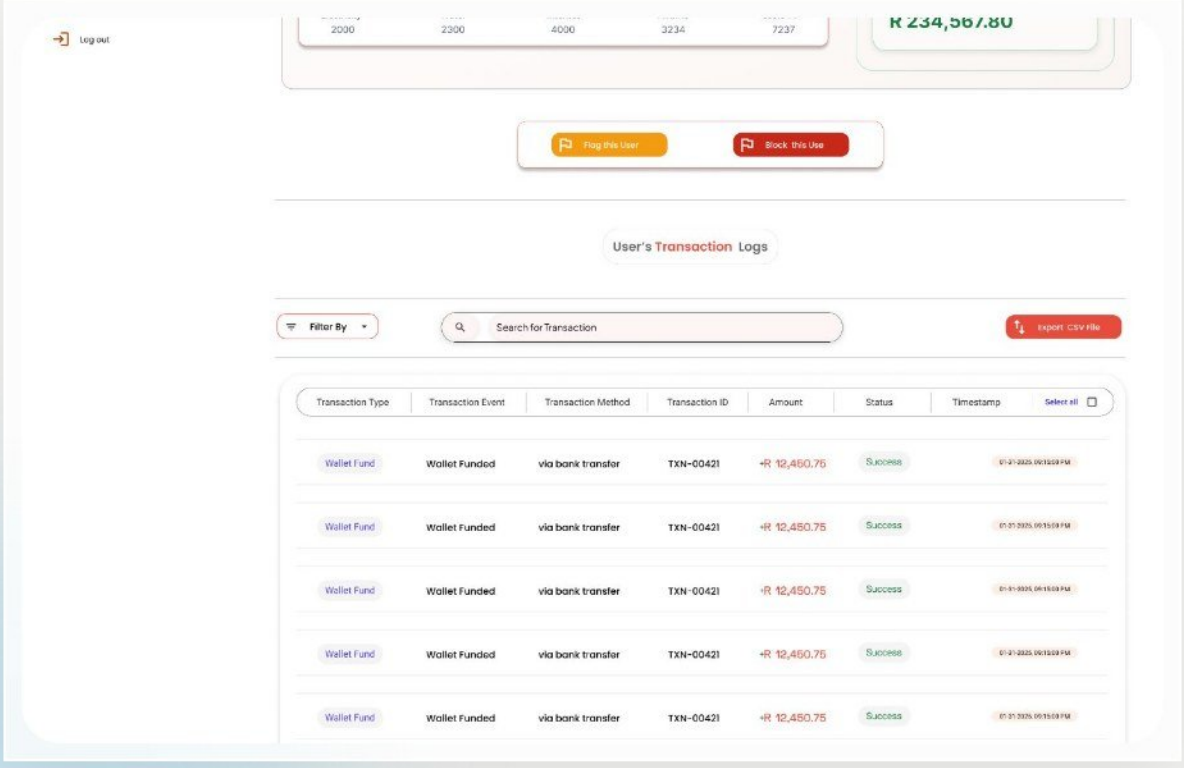
DESIGN SYSTEMS

I built my first design system backwards. Here's what I'd do instead.





Philip Nosike · 5 min read

01

The fix was making decisions before shapes

I went back and started with tokens: the small, named decisions underneath everything. Which colour means “do this.” How much space sits between related things. How big a heading is. Each product could then use those same decisions at its own size.

DESIGN SYSTEMS



If a developer has to ask which grey to use, the system has already let them down.

Two mistakes I won't repeat

1. Naming things by how they look ("blue-500") instead of what they do ("action-primary").

2. Writing the documentation in a separate file nobody opened. Notes inside the components did more than any handbook.

READ THE FULL STORY

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thenoskshade.netlify.app/blog →



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